
Alexander Dao

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Education

University of California, Santa Cruz
Linguistics Major, Computer Science Minor

Santa Cruz, CA
Winter 2027

Thesis: The Visual Word Form Area, Autism, and Childhood Hyperlexia

Relevant Coursework: CSE 13S (C Programming), CSE 40 (Machine Learning), CSE 150 (Advanced Networking)

Experience

The American Prospect
Editorial Intern

Santa Cruz
January 2026 – Present

- Responsible for research, fact-checking, social media, data entry, and library services for the print magazine and the daily website.
- Expectations include editorial contributions, writing briefs and articles as assigned, generating story ideas, and pursuing individual projects with staff guidance.

Paystand
Content Analytics Intern

Santa Cruz
June 2024 – January 2025

- Developed essential data entry and analytics skills
- Tracked metrics for C-suite to improve engagement with community

Leadership & Activities

Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers
Member

Santa Cruz
November 2025 - Present

- Society of engineers from all Hispanic backgrounds, affiliated with clubs such as the National Society of Black Engineers (NSBE) and MESA. There is no requirement to be of Hispanic background; was invited by several friends including ranking officers and the current club president.

Math, Engineering & Science Achievement Program (MESA)
Member

Santa Cruz
February 2025 - Present

- Joint peer and staff-led mathematics, engineering, and sciences club @ UC Santa Cruz. Supports achievement for under-represented first-generation college students.

Skills & Interests

Technical: C, Python (Statistical Analysis, ML, CCNA-level Networking), HTML + CSS (self-hosted website)

Language: English (Native), Vietnamese (Heritage), Japanese (JLPT N2-level fluency)

Laboratory: Neurolinguistics w/ Prof. Dustin A. Chacon, Advanced Networking w/ Prof. Christina Parsa

Interests: Sketching, Cycling, Sailing